

456 Bridge Road,
Cobblebank Victoria, 3338

Parent Code of Conduct Policy

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to set out the conduct expected of parents, guardians and carers at Rosewood College.

Rosewood College (the College) recognises parents as the primary educators of their children and seeks to work in close partnership with families. This policy supports a school community marked by trust, respect, responsibility, child safety and shared commitment to the formation of students.

This policy also supports the College's duty of care, child safety obligations, staff wellbeing, complaints handling, student wellbeing, enrolment relationships, family engagement and the safe operation of College activities.

2. Scope

This policy applies to parents, guardians, carers and family members of current and prospective students.

It applies in all interactions connected with the College, including:

- on College grounds
- at arrival, dismissal, late arrival and early collection
- at school events, meetings, liturgies, assemblies, excursions and offsite activities
- during enrolment, mentoring, wellbeing, behaviour or learning discussions
- in written, verbal, digital and social media communication
- when communicating with staff, students, parents, volunteers, contractors, visitors or members of the wider community about College matters
- when volunteering, attending events or participating in College activities
- when participating in parent communication groups or informal parent networks connected with College life

3. Policy

3.1 Parent partnership principles

Parents and guardians are expected to support a respectful partnership between home and the College.

Parents and guardians are expected to:

- uphold the dignity and safety of every student
- communicate respectfully with staff and other members of the College community
- support the College's Catholic identity, philosophy, values and behaviour expectations
- support the College's Student Behaviour Management Policy and related behaviour expectations
- work constructively with staff in the best interests of students
- use appropriate College communication and complaint pathways
- respect privacy, confidentiality and procedural fairness
- comply with reasonable directions relating to safety, supervision, visitor access and College operations
- model conduct that supports student formation in virtue, responsibility and respect
- read and comply with College policies, procedures, handbooks and reasonable operational requirements communicated to families
- respond to College communications, forms, permissions and requests for information within the timeframe requested
- attend required parent functions, mentor meetings, learning discussions and other meetings requested by the College, unless alternative arrangements have been made with the College
- keep the College informed of information relevant to their child's learning, behaviour, health, safety, family circumstances or wellbeing
- recognise that the College considers parent requests and new information, but cannot necessarily accommodate every request

3.2 Respectful communication

Parents and guardians must communicate with staff, students and other members of the College community in a manner that is respectful, truthful and constructive.

Unacceptable conduct includes:

- aggression, intimidation, threats or harassment
- abusive, insulting, discriminatory or degrading language
- persistent unreasonable demands or communications
- shouting, swearing or hostile behaviour
- public criticism of staff, students or families in a way that undermines safety, dignity or trust
- spreading rumours or confidential information

- using social media to target, shame, harass or undermine staff, students, families or the College
- retaliation against a person who raises a concern or complaint

Parents and guardians must recognise the damage that gossip, speculation, rumour and unconstructive commentary can cause within a school community.

3.3 Communication with staff

Parents and guardians are expected to communicate with staff through approved College channels.

Parents and guardians must:

- make an appointment if they wish to meet with a staff member
- use College communication channels rather than staff personal contact details or personal online accounts
- respect staff working time, privacy and professional boundaries
- respond respectfully and promptly when a staff member requests a meeting about a student's learning, behaviour, attendance, safety or wellbeing
- avoid raising complex, sensitive or confidential matters during arrival, dismissal, public events or times when staff are supervising students
- allow staff reasonable time to consider and respond to communications

Parents and guardians must not:

- contact staff at their home or through personal social media accounts
- pressure staff to respond outside reasonable working expectations
- record staff conversations or meetings without consent
- confront staff in public or in the presence of students
- attempt to direct staff in the performance of their duties

3.4 Child safety and student wellbeing

Parents and guardians must support the College's child-safe culture.

Parents and guardians must:

- comply with child safety, visitor, supervision and offsite activity requirements
- avoid unsupervised contact with students unless authorised by the College
- report child safety or wellbeing concerns promptly to the Principal or another appropriate staff member
- respect boundaries with students, including online and physical boundaries
- avoid photographing, recording or sharing images of students except where permitted by the College
- follow staff directions during emergencies, evacuations, lockdowns, first aid incidents or safety concerns
- respect student privacy and supervision boundaries around the Toilet Building, First Aid Room, classrooms, student movement routes and supervised play areas

Concerns involving child safety, mandatory reporting, reportable conduct, criminal conduct or immediate risk must be escalated under the relevant College procedure and must not be treated only as a general complaint.

3.5 Student needs, family circumstances and risk information

Parents and guardians must provide the College with accurate and current information needed to support student learning, safety and wellbeing.

Parents and guardians are expected to inform the College as soon as practicable about:

- medical, health, allergy, medication, disability or wellbeing needs
- behavioural, educational, personal or family circumstances that may affect the student at school
- changes to emergency contacts, authorised collection arrangements or court orders
- incidents outside school, including online conduct, that may affect the safety, wellbeing or learning of any student
- any concern that a student may be unsafe, distressed, bullied, excluded, harmed or at risk

The College uses this information to assess risk, provide support, meet legal obligations and maintain a safe environment for students, staff and families.

3.6 Respect for staff roles and professional judgement

Parents and guardians are expected to respect the professional role of staff and the operational authority of the Principal.

Parents and guardians may raise concerns, ask questions and request clarification, but must not:

- direct staff in the performance of their duties
- discipline or question another person's child
- approach another student about a behaviour, conflict or complaint matter
- interfere with supervision, teaching, emergency response or behaviour management
- seek confidential information about another student, family or staff member
- pressure staff to act outside policy, procedure or professional judgement
- undermine the authority of staff in front of students or other members of the College community

The College is responsible for assessing behaviour matters and determining appropriate responses in accordance with its policies and procedures. Parents and guardians may raise concerns through the Complaints and Grievances Policy and Procedure, but must not undermine staff authority, interfere with investigations or attempt to resolve student behaviour matters directly with other students or families.

3.7 Arrival, dismissal and movement through the site

Parents and guardians must follow College arrangements for arrival, dismissal, late arrival, early collection and visitor access.

Parents and guardians are expected to:

- use the approved student and visitor entry arrangements

- report to Reception when required
- follow staff directions during arrival, dismissal, early collection, events, emergencies and changes to ordinary access arrangements
- remain in parent, visitor or event areas unless authorised to enter another area
- avoid entering classrooms, staff areas, administration areas, the Northern Service Yard, Southern Service Yard, storage areas, contractor areas or student toilet areas unless authorised by staff
- supervise younger siblings or accompanying children while onsite
- avoid blocking gates, paths, ramps, stairs, emergency access, service access or supervised student movement routes
- leave promptly when requested by staff for safety, supervision or operational reasons

Parents and guardians must not approach a student other than their own child about a behaviour, conflict, complaint or supervision matter. Concerns about another student must be raised with staff.

3.8 Student collection and handover

Parents and guardians must comply with the College's student collection and handover arrangements.

Parents and guardians are expected to:

- ensure the College has current parent, guardian and emergency contact details
- ensure authorised collection information is accurate and current
- notify the College of absences, late arrivals and early collections in accordance with College procedures
- report to Reception for late arrival and early collection where required
- wait for staff to release a student before taking the student from College supervision
- follow staff instructions if a collection arrangement is unclear, changed or cannot be verified
- avoid calling students away from supervised areas without staff knowledge and approval
- follow emergency collection or reunification instructions if ordinary collection arrangements change

The College does not release a student where collection authority is uncertain or where release would create a foreseeable safety risk.

3.9 Separated parents and family disputes

The College seeks to maintain appropriate communication with parents and guardians in accordance with enrolment records, legal obligations and any court orders or formal parenting arrangements provided to the College.

Parents and guardians must not ask the College to take sides in parental, family or relationship disputes.

Parents and guardians are expected to:

- provide the College with current court orders or formal arrangements relevant to student safety, communication, access or collection

- avoid using College staff, records, events, communication systems or student collection arrangements to pursue a family dispute
- communicate with the College respectfully and factually about matters affecting the student
- understand that the College complies with applicable legal obligations and acts in the student's best interests and safety

3.10 Raising concerns and complaints

The College welcomes concerns raised in good faith through appropriate channels.

Parents and guardians are expected to:

- raise concerns early and respectfully
- use the Complaints and Grievances Policy and Procedure where a matter requires formal resolution
- allow the College reasonable time to assess and respond
- provide accurate information
- respect confidentiality and procedural fairness
- avoid escalating concerns through gossip, social media or inappropriate community pressure

Raising a complaint in good faith will not disadvantage a student or family. However, complaint rights do not permit threatening, abusive, unsafe, defamatory, unreasonable or public conduct that undermines the safety, dignity or reputation of staff, students, families or the College.

Parents and guardians must not use gossip, speculation, social media, class groups or community pressure as a substitute for the College's complaints process.

Where a matter involves another student, another family, child safety, behaviour management, bullying, an investigation or a confidential College process, parents and guardians must raise the matter with the College and must not approach another student, parent or family without College knowledge and consent.

3.11 Attendance, punctuality and student responsibilities

Parents and guardians support student conduct and learning by:

- ensuring students attend school regularly and punctually
- notifying the College of absences in accordance with attendance procedures
- supporting uniform, presentation, technology and behaviour expectations
- providing accurate health, medical, wellbeing and contact information
- working with staff where a student requires additional support
- supporting agreed student management, wellbeing or learning plans

3.12 Privacy and confidentiality

Parents and guardians must respect the privacy and dignity of others.

Parents and guardians must not:

- share confidential information about students, families, staff or College matters without authority
- record meetings, conversations, classes, events or incidents without permission
- publish images or information about other students without appropriate consent
- misuse parent contact details, class information or College communications
- seek access to records or information to which they are not entitled
- photograph or record students in toilets, first aid areas, classrooms, supervised play areas or other sensitive spaces

3.13 Technology, social media and parent communication groups

Parents and guardians must use technology, social media and parent communication groups responsibly.

Parents and guardians must not:

- use social media, messaging groups, email or online forums to bully, harass, shame, defame or undermine staff, students, parents, families or the College
- publish confidential, sensitive or personal information about staff, students, parents or College matters without authority
- publish images, recordings or personal information about students other than their own child without appropriate consent
- publish images or recordings that show inappropriate behaviour by students, staff, parents or community members connected with the College
- discuss grievances about individual staff, students or families online
- use the College's name, logo, insignia or identity for an online group, publication, forum or communication channel in a way that suggests College endorsement without written approval
- contact staff through personal social media accounts or personal online platforms about College matters

Concerns about online behaviour, images, recordings, messaging groups or digital communication that affect student safety or wellbeing must be raised with the College.

3.14 Use of College grounds and events

Parents and guardians must comply with College directions regarding:

- signing in and visitor access
- supervision zones and restricted areas
- arrival, dismissal, pedestrian access and student handover arrangements
- emergency and evacuation procedures
- student collection and authorised contacts
- event attendance and conduct
- site-specific safety requirements

Parents and guardians must not enter restricted or controlled areas unless authorised by staff.

Restricted or controlled areas may include:

- staff work areas
- administration work areas, including the Office and Principal's Office
- student toilet areas
- the First Aid Room, except where invited by staff
- the Northern Service Yard and Southern Service Yard
- utility or plant areas
- contractor work zones
- storage areas
- unattended buildings
- emergency access and service access areas

Parents and guardians attending College events must:

- model respectful conduct for students
- follow the directions of staff, event supervisors, coaches, officials and authorised College representatives
- avoid abusive, threatening, intimidating or undermining behaviour toward staff, volunteers, officials, students, parents or visitors
- accept that staff make decisions about student participation, grouping, selection and supervision in accordance with College responsibilities and professional judgement

3.15 Volunteering and parent participation

Parents and guardians who volunteer or participate in College activities must comply with all applicable screening, induction, child safety, supervision, privacy and staff direction requirements.

Volunteering or parent participation does not give a parent or guardian authority to:

- supervise students independently unless authorised by the College
- access confidential information
- discipline students
- direct staff or students outside the role approved by the College
- enter restricted areas without authorisation
- take photographs, videos or recordings except where authorised
- use volunteer access to advance a personal complaint or family dispute

3.16 Managing breaches of this policy

Where a parent or guardian breaches this policy, the College may take action that is reasonable, proportionate and directed to safety, respectful communication and the continued education of the student.

Possible responses include:

- reminder of expectations
- request to communicate through a nominated staff member

- meeting with the Principal
- written warning
- limits on access to a staff member or group of staff members
- requirement that communication occur only in writing or only through a nominated staff member
- limits on access to College grounds or events
- revised communication arrangements
- requirement to report to Reception before entering College areas
- exclusion from volunteering or specific activities
- suspension from attendance at functions, activities or events for a specified period
- requirement to attend a meeting before further attendance onsite or at events
- direction to leave the site
- removal from, or refusal of participation in, parent communication groups, volunteering or informal activities connected with the College
- escalation under child safety, complaints, emergency, privacy or legal procedures
- referral to external authorities where required
- consideration of enrolment implications where conduct seriously undermines safety, trust or the College's ability to educate the student

Any action must take into account student welfare, procedural fairness, child safety, duty of care, disability and vulnerability considerations, and the seriousness and context of the conduct.

4. Implementation

The Principal is responsible for implementing this policy.

The Principal is responsible for:

- communicating this policy to parents and guardians
- ensuring staff know how to respond to parent conduct concerns
- managing serious or repeated conduct concerns
- ensuring child safety matters are escalated appropriately
- maintaining records of significant parent conduct issues
- reporting significant risks, incidents or patterns to the Governing Authority where appropriate
- ensuring arrival, dismissal, visitor access and collection expectations are reflected in parent communication
- ensuring parent partnership expectations are reflected in the Parent Handbook, enrolment communication and induction processes

Staff are responsible for:

- modelling respectful communication

- maintaining professional boundaries
- applying visitor, arrival, dismissal and student collection arrangements
- referring serious or repeated concerns to the Principal
- recording relevant parent conduct concerns in approved College systems
- following child safety, complaints, privacy and incident procedures where applicable
- using approved College communication channels when communicating with parents and guardians

Parents and guardians are responsible for:

- reading and following this policy
- supporting respectful partnership between home and the College
- raising concerns through appropriate channels
- complying with staff directions while onsite or participating in College activities
- ensuring other family members attending College activities understand and follow relevant conduct expectations
- keeping student, family, medical, contact, collection and court order information accurate and current
- supporting the College's behaviour, attendance, uniform, technology and safety expectations

Records are maintained in accordance with the College's privacy, complaints, incident and records management requirements.

5. Review

This policy will be reviewed at least every three years, or earlier if required due to:

- a serious parent conduct, child safety, complaints or safety incident
- changes to legislation, Ministerial Orders, VRQA guidance or registration expectations
- changes to the College's buildings, access points, student access boundaries, Site Supervision Map, supervision, student collection or operational arrangements
- changes to related College policies or procedures
- feedback from staff, parents, guardians or the Governing Authority
- a governance or operational review identifying that the policy is unclear, incomplete or ineffective

The Principal is responsible for coordinating review.

Material amendments must be approved by the Governing Authority.

6. Related Documents

Related documents include:

- Complaints and Grievances Policy
- Enrolment Agreement

- Parent Handbook
- Student Code of Conduct Policy